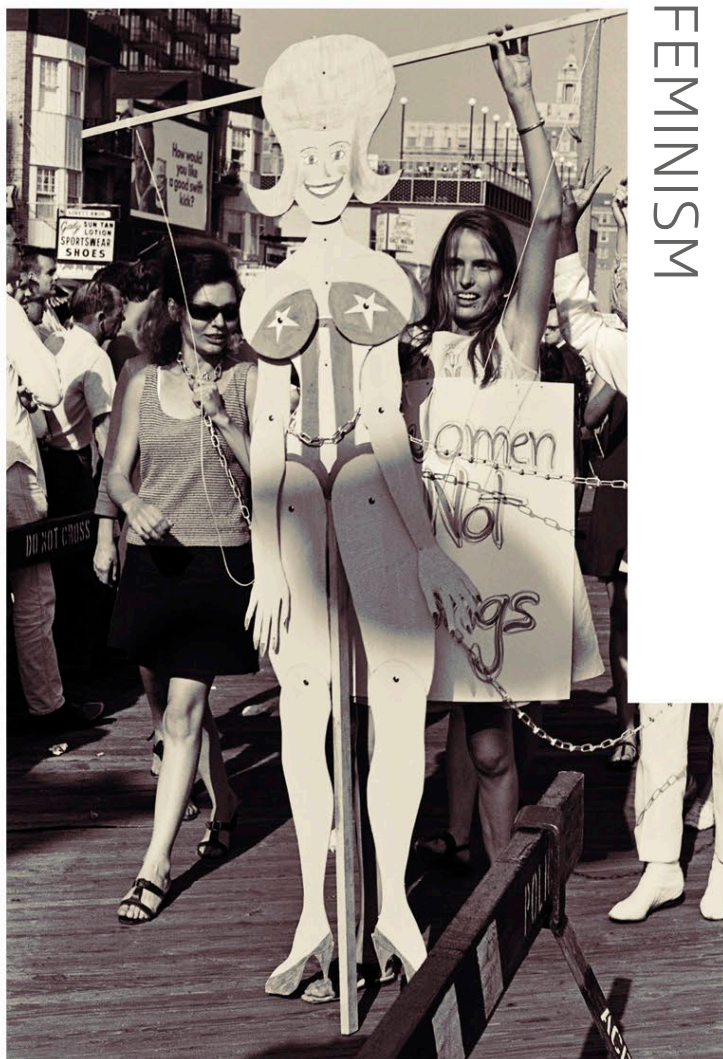


THE PERSONAL GETS political

▼ No More Miss America!

Protestors take to the Atlantic City boardwalk in 1968 to protest against the objectification of women and the tyrannical beauty standards enforced by the annual national pageant.



SECOND-WAVE FEMINISM

Second wave feminism burst onto the political and social scene in the 1960s and continued until the late 1980s or early 1990s. Often called the Women's Liberation Movement, it began in Western industrialized nations but eventually spread worldwide. The Women's Liberation Movement (WLM) was rooted in a belief that, despite the achievements of first-wave feminism, most aspects of society were inherently sexist and designed to oppress women or discriminate against them. In 1963, Betty Friedan's *The Feminine Mystique* demonstrated how white middle-class women were oppressed. Other definitive works followed, such as Germaine Greer's *The Female Eunuch* (1970), which argued that the female body had been used to make women be seen as "other," leading to discrimination.

The liberation movement in the US was sparked by a general atmosphere of activism; the 1960s was a decade of protest, from Civil Rights marches to student sit-ins and demonstrations against the Vietnam War. Female activists, hearing their male colleagues dismiss women's concerns, broke away to create what became a crusade for women's liberation. The first US Women's Liberation conference met in Chicago in 1967. A year later, 400 feminists protested against the objectification of women at the Miss America beauty pageant, making women's liberation front page news.

Beginnings

The WLM spread abroad. In Mexico, women protested at the Monument to the Mother against the idea that women should all bear children. Feminists in New Zealand invaded men-only pubs. Meanwhile, British feminists such as Sheila Rowbotham and Juliet Mitchell held the first British Women's Liberation conference in 1970, in Oxford. The WLM

